

Flight Booking User Persona

Context & Role

Travellers use the flight booking system to search for routes, compare options, and book flights for work or personal trips. They often have limited time, may be booking on their phone, and need clear information about times, prices, and basic conditions (e.g. baggage, changes). They want to quickly find suitable flights, enter passenger details, pay securely, and later review or adjust their bookings without having to call customer support.

Pain Points

- Confusing search forms that make it hard to set dates, destinations, or number of passengers.
- Long, multi-page booking processes where it is easy to make mistakes in names or dates.
- Lack of a clear overview of existing bookings, making it hard to find reference numbers or flight times.
- Difficulty changing or cancelling a booking online, especially when plans change close to departure.
- Not receiving timely notifications when a change, cancellation, or request has been processed.

Goals & Success

The main goal for travellers is to book the right flight as quickly and confidently as possible, and to be able to manage that booking afterwards without stress. Success means they can search for flights by route, date, and passenger count, see clear options and prices, and complete the booking in a small number of simple steps. A successful system lets them review all their bookings in one place, request changes or cancellations online, and receive confirmations and updates without needing to contact airline staff manually.

Constraints & Non-Goals

Travellers have limited patience for complex or slow systems and are often multitasking while booking. They do not want to learn airline internal processes or deal with back-office terminology. Advanced staff features like detailed operational reports or internal availability rules are not a priority for them, as long as they can easily find flights, complete payment, and manage their own reservations.

User Stories

Flight Search and Availability

As a flight booking customer, I can search for flights by departure airport, destination airport, travel dates, and number of passengers, so that I can quickly see which options are available for my trip without trying multiple websites.

Booking and Payment

As a flight booking customer, I can select a preferred flight, enter passenger details (name and email), and complete secure payment in a clear sequence of steps, so that I can confirm my booking with confidence and receive a booking reference.

Booking Review and Management

As a flight booking customer, I can view all my existing bookings and see key details such as dates, times, destinations, and booking references in one place, so that I can easily check my travel plans and provide information when needed.

Change and Cancellation Requests

As a flight booking customer, I can request changes to my booking (such as updating flight dates or passenger information) or cancel a flight and receive confirmation of the outcome, so that I can handle unexpected changes to my plans without calling support.

Notifications

As a flight booking customer, I can receive notifications when my booking is confirmed, changed, or cancelled, so that I always know the status of my flights.

I created one main **persona** to keep us focused when we design the flight booking system.

- His name is Rohan, he's 29, and he works as a management consultant in Leeds.
- He flies a lot for work, usually 2–3 times a month and often books flights last-minute on his phone between meetings.
- His main **goal** is to quickly find and book a suitable flight without wasting time.
- His **pain points** are slow or confusing booking flows, having to re-enter the same details, and not being able to easily see or change his bookings later.

The idea is: when we design search, booking, and 'view my bookings', we imagine we're building it for Rohan, not just a random user."

I also wrote one **user story** for Rohan that we can turn into actual tasks:

As a frequent business traveller, I want to search for flights by departure airport, destination, travel dates, and number of passengers so that I can quickly find options that fit my schedule.

This tells us three things:

- **Who** it's for: a frequent business traveller like Rohan.

- **What** they need: a clear search where they can set route, dates, and passenger count.
- **Why** it matters: they can quickly find suitable flights.